

without warning or perform erratically. If something's not working on this page, please come back and try it again later." We should note that one product has been in the labs since 2002! We expect it will never graduate—we're referring to Google Sets.

At <http://labs.google.com>, you can find all the Google Labs prototypes, as well as those that have "graduated"—such as Google Scholar and Google Maps. Each Labs title has two links: one for sending feedback, and one for discussing the product, as in a forum.

Unfortunately, feedback for these products isn't in the form of a Web form with ratings and such: you can only send a plain e-mail to the developer! You might be more comfortable getting to the forums by clicking the "Discuss with others" link. You need to have a Google Account, and you also need to join the group to be able to post messages. You can, of course, read what others are saying without having to join the group.

The content posted on these forums is typical of this mode of communication, though the forums seem to be heavily moderated—you don't see any junk messages at all! Messages range in content from suggestions (what Google wants), questions on usage, interesting uses or features people have discovered, and such. Each group also has a presence in the new Google Groups Beta—so there's an option on each groups page to "View the page in Groups Beta." Google Groups has been dealt with elsewhere in this book.

It's come down to this: if you're helping improve Google, you're helping make the world a better place! We urge you to join the discussions, and possibly even send e-mail directly to the developers if you have something good enough (or bad enough) to say.

Also, at <http://labs.google.com/papers/index.html>, you'll find interesting (and some difficult) papers related to Google technology. Some are showcased on this page, but there are more—and, naturally, there's a search bar for you to find what you're looking for. Just to give you an idea of what you can expect, here are four sample titles:

*WebSearch for a Planet: The Google Cluster Architecture*, by Luiz André Barroso, Jeffrey Dean, and Urs Hölzle

*Extracting knowledge from the World Wide Web*, by Monika Henzinger and Steve Lawrence

*Searching the Web by Voice*, by Alex Franz and Brian Milch

*The Price of Performance: An Economic Case for Chip Multiprocessing*, by Luiz André Barroso

A couple of points before we begin. We will *not* be talking about the following at [labs.google.com](http://labs.google.com), and for the reasons mentioned.

1. The Graduates of the Labs, since these are released products and are not open to feedback; also because they have been talked about elsewhere in this book. Ditto Google Code Search and Reader.
2. Google Transit, because it only covers only a few cities in the US.
3. Google Trends in Chinese, because we can't understand what's on the page.
4. Picasa for Linux, because Picasa has been discussed elsewhere in this book. What you'll find at the forum for this page is problems people are facing with installing Picasa for Linux. If you have a problem, post it at the forum page (<http://groups.google.com/group/Google-Labs-Picasa-for-Linux>) and hope it'll be answered. (*Space doesn't permit a discussion of common Linux installation problems, either.*)
5. Google Mars, because there's a section devoted to it in this book.
6. Google Dashboard Widgets for Mac, because there are only three Widgets available. Just for information's sake, however, here's what the Widgets are: